



Money Path

Game Development — Milestones & Acceptance Criteria

Web → iOS → Android

Single-file web game

Built daily with Claude Code

Version 1.0 · 2026-06-05 · Owner: Vendetta1777 · github.com/Vendetta1777/money-path

A milestone **graduates** only when **every** acceptance criterion is met. Dates are honest targets, not promises. Mirror of GitHub Milestones.

The daily ritual — each session = one small, shippable improvement:

1. **Pick** — read the Dev Log + open GitHub issues; choose one tied to the current milestone.
2. **Build** → **Test** → **Ship** — implement, validate (node --check + headless-Chrome playwright), commit, push.
3. **Log** — record what shipped, decisions, a Coach's note, and the next step; update the issue.

M0 — Pre-Production: Foundation & Workflow

due 2026-06-06

Set up so every future day compounds.

- ☒ Game Design Document exists
- ☒ Roadmap + acceptance criteria + this PDF
- ☒ GitHub as a tracker: labels, milestones, starter backlog
- ☒ Persistent dev memory started (Dev Log)
- ☒ Daily workflow ritual + /session command

Graduated ☒ **2026-06-05** — foundation in place.

M1 — Vertical Slice: a polished, shippable core loop

due 2026-06-19

Make the existing game "store-demo quality." Depth before breadth.

- ☐ Shareable result card (image/text) + "challenge a friend" — the viral loop
- ☐ Deterministic seed (seeded RNG) → reproducible runs + a Daily Challenge
- ☐ Balance pass: no dominant strategy; all-save is survivable-but-low, not instant burnout
- ☐ Mobile-responsive + installable PWA
- ☐ Accessibility: contrast, font scaling, reduced-motion
- ☐ Onboarding: a guided first run

Graduates when: a first-time player on a phone can **start, understand, finish, and share** a run with zero confusion.

M2 — Content Engine: agentic stories / characters / levels

due 2026-07-10

Stop hand-coding content; generate and validate it.

- ☐ Content schema (data, not code) for characters, scenarios/"levels", story arcs
- ☐ Move existing events/dilemmas/lives into that schema (game loads from data)
- ☐ /new-character generator → valid, on-tone character file
- ☐ /new-scenario generator + validator (rejects broken/unbalanced content)
- ☐ ≥ 10 new scenarios + 3 characters added through the pipeline

Graduates when: a brand-new scenario can be **generated, validated, and played** without editing engine code.

M3 — Web Distribution + Analytics

due 2026-07-31

- ☐ Privacy-friendly analytics with key funnel events (start, finish, share, replay)
- ☐ Error/telemetry logging
- ☐ A small landing page + clean URL (custom domain or itch.io)
- ☐ Versioned releases (tags + changelog)

Graduates when: we can **see how many play, where they drop off**, and ship updates confidently.

M4 — Mobile: iOS + Android

due 2026-08-21

- ☐ Wrap with Capacitor → native iOS + Android builds
- ☐ App icon, splash, store screenshots, metadata
- ☐ Runs on simulator + a real device; haptics/sound feel native
- ☐ Internal test track (TestFlight / Play internal)

Graduates when: the game **installs and plays well from a phone home screen** on both platforms.

M5 — Launch & Live-Ops

due 2026-09-11

- ☐ Store submission (App Store + Play) passes review
- ☐ Retention loop (daily challenge, streaks) live
- ☐ Content cadence: new scenarios shipped regularly via the engine
- ☐ Basic store optimization (title, keywords, screenshots)

Graduates when: **real strangers can download it**, and we ship fresh content on a schedule.

Coach's note — why this order?

Studios build a **vertical slice** (one polished slice that proves the fun) *before* adding breadth (M1), then a **content engine** so the game can grow without hand-coding every level (M2), then **distribution + analytics** to learn from real players (M3), and only then **port to mobile** and **launch** (M4–M5). Pre-production (M0) is cheapest place to be smart: changing a plan costs minutes; changing shipped code costs days.